



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Faith Lutheran School  
School Website: <https://www.fllderby.com/>

December 22, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Faith Lutheran School Derby KS 67037 presents a clearly confessional, Christian, classical-inclined approach within a K–6 setting. The school emphasizes Jesus Christ, a Biblical worldview, and liturgical or family-centered practices, and it explicitly notes a transition to a classical model of education. The curriculum incorporates classical resources (Latin, Memoria Press, Veritas Press, Progeny Press, etc.) and a structure that resembles classical education (grammar-type subjects in the early grades, memorable Bible-based recitations, and a phonics/classical literature emphasis). Pedagogy includes singing, memory work, and devotional life in lower grades, with evidence of Socratic-style elements not clearly documented in the public materials for upper grades. The school foregrounds parental partnership and family-faith formation as core elements of the program.

Overall aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- This evaluation leans toward a classical spine (theology-infused formation, classical curriculum materials, explicit classical modeling), but the public materials do not consistently demonstrate full classical criteria (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation exposure, explicit Socratic seminars, and explicit articulation of transformation through formation rather than information across all grades). See category-by-category details below.
- What would move the needle: more explicit articulation and visibility of Great Books/Great Conversation, explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and a clearly defined, public-facing “formation through virtue and wisdom” statement that ties direct evidence of traditional liberal-arts pedagogy (grammar-logic-rhetoric) across all grade bands; plus a public commitment to liturgical rhythms as a patterned, ongoing practice in the upper grades (beyond chapel and family worship).

### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence: Public materials center Christ, Scripture, and a Biblical worldview. Examples include “Biblical worldview to help them grow and develop a life-long relationship with Jesus Christ” and explicit Christ-centered language, including family worship and Lutheran faith foundations.  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Jesus Christ, Biblical worldview, Christ-centered, Theology, daily chapel, family worship, Lutheran education, family devotionals. Negative keywords (values-neutral, secular) are not present in the public materials. Approximate positive keyword count far exceeds any negative signals (10+ positives vs 0 negatives identified here). This supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category. Why this rating: The materials foreground sacred tradition, liturgical life, and theological grounding as core to education, aligning with transcendental and theological elements of classical education.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: The school emphasizes formation through a Biblical worldview and Christ-like living, and notes the school transitioned to a classical model in 2023. Public statements assert aims of shaping students “to live for Him,” with a classical-model framing. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Biblical

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worldview, Christ-like living, formation through a classical model, and the claim of a transition to classical education. There is limited explicit language about “virtue” or “wisdom” as explicit goals beyond formation in a Christian sense; no explicit negative keywords are evident. Relative to the Six Elements rubric, the formation/teleology is present but not fully explicit in the exact classical phrasing (e.g., “formation not information,” or explicit virtue/wisdom teleology). Why this rating: The purpose is strongly oriented to formation and Christ-centered aims, which is classical-adjacent, but the explicit articulation of virtue/wisdom as universal goals and the precise departure from information-focused aims is not as publicly explicit as the strongest classical formulations.

- **Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The curriculum uses classical resources and a literature/grammar emphasis (e.g., Latin from Memoria Press, Shurley English, Progeny Press, Veritas Press, One in Christ Bible curriculum, Saxon Math). The school notes a classical model of learning and features a multi-grade structure with Bible, literature, grammar, spelling, and Latin in the early grades; it includes “classical literature” and “novel studies.”  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include “classical literature,” “Latin,” “Memoria Press,” “Shurley English,” “Veritas Press,” “Unearthing classical materials,” and “classical model of learning.” This aligns with a significant portion of the classical curriculum indicators. The explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric triad (the core of classical curricula) is evidenced by grammar (Shurley English, Memoria Press), logic/rhetoric are not always named in the public materials; the “great books/great conversation” language is not explicit in the public materials. Negative keywords are not evident. Why this rating: The presence of classical resources and a stated classical model signals a substantial classical curricular orientation, but the absence of explicit high-school-level Great Books exposure and explicit logic/rhetoric emphasis in the public materials (and the grade-band scope described) supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL score rather than CLASSICAL.
- **Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Pedagogy includes lower-grade singing and memorization, daily Bible devotionals, and recitation (e.g., Bible memory verses, manners, poetry), with a progression into more formal study, and upper grades reportedly employing Socratic-style discussion and rhetoric training in classical curricula discussions. However, explicit public evidence of ongoing Socratic seminars or debates for upper grades is not clearly documented in the website content; there is clear evidence of memory-based and liturgical elements in the lower grades and a stated classical approach overall.  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “recitations,” “memory,” “singing,” “devotion,” “chapel,” “Socratic discussion” (mentioned in the rubric as a potential for classical pedagogy, though not consistently evidenced in public materials for all grades), and “rhetoric” training language appears in the rubric rather than explicit site text. Negative keywords (e.g., “experiential learning,” “project-based learning”) do not appear as dominant patterns; the site emphasizes contemplation/memory in early grades and discussion in theory in later grades. Given the lack of explicit, consistent Socratic/seminar pedagogy across the site, the category sits at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The lower grades emphasize contemplative recall and liturgical life; upper grades claim classical pedagogy in theory but public documentation of consistent Socratic seminars is not strong, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- **Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site describes faculty as “dedicated teachers,” who deeply love the Lord, value education, and care for students; there is a claim of faculty as a living part of the school and a tight, relational culture (Our Staff; Meet the Staff; close teacher-student rapport). Some language hints at the faculty as the core or living curriculum, though not always explicit in public materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “dedicated teachers,” “living curriculum” (conceptually present in some sections), “core of the school,” and “Christ-centered” education; explicit phrases like “living curriculum” appear in the knowledge base text rather than on every page, but the sentiment is present. Negative keywords are not evidenced. The overall signal is supportive of classical aims, but the explicit articulation of a formal “portrait of what a teacher should be” or a robust “model teachers/mentors” descriptor is not strongly depicted in the public site text. Why this rating: The public-facing materials indicate a strong, virtuous teacher culture and a close faculty-student dynamic, which aligns with classical “living curriculum” expectations, but

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with limited explicit, codified detail in the site text, it lands at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school foregrounds partnership with parents, parent education resources, and open access for visits. There are explicit statements about partnering with parents as co-teachers and providing family devotionals/activities, as well as opportunities to visit and tour the school. The site also references family worship resources and Lutheran education materials to involve parents. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include “partner with parents,” “co-teachers,” “family devotionals,” “family worship,” “Lutheran Education,” “Lutheran Church,” and “open visits.” These align well with the classical-pedagogy emphasis on formation through family/communal life. Negative keywords are not present. This results in a clear CLASSICAL signal for Element 6. Why this rating: The explicit emphasis on parent partnership and family-faith formation aligns strongly with classical education’s model of formation through a joint home-school catechetical cycle, making this category CLASSICAL.

Overall, Faith Lutheran School Derby KS 67037 shows a strong classical-influenced profile with robust religious formation, a classical resources spine, and active parent engagement, but with less explicit and uniform evidence of fully realized classical pedagogy (Socratic inquiry, Great Books/Great Conversation across all grades, and explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric progression across all grades). This combination lands the school in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with Element 6 clearly CLASSICAL and Element 1 clearly CLASSICAL, and Element 3 and Element 4 showing meaningful classical elements but not the full, explicit classical form across all grade bands.

What Would Move the Needle (for a move to CLASSICAL)

- Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit in public materials: publish a formal statement that the curriculum includes Great Books or canonical Western literary works appropriate to each grade band, plus explicit connections to the Great Conversation across grades, with sample book lists and learning objectives.
- Publicly document a clear logic-rhetoric trajectory: provide a visible map showing how grammar, logic, and rhetoric are sequenced across K–6 (or K–8) with specific courses or modules named and described (e.g., introductory logic in late elementary; formal rhetoric and public speaking in upper elementary).
- Expand explicit Socratic pedagogy for upper grades: publish classroom models or videos showing Socratic seminars, debates, and seminar-style learning in practice, with teacher guides and student-learning objectives.
- Strengthen the “formation” teleology: publish a concise, public-facing framework that ties formation of virtue, wisdom, and character to specific classroom practices, assessments, and chapel- and family-faith routines.
- Enhance liturgical & contemplative practices as a formal strand: lay out a calendar and program of liturgical formation (not only family worship and chapel, but school-wide liturgical seasons, devotional rhythms, and sacred music curricula) with explicit alignment to classical pedagogy.
- Continue to articulate parental partnership as a core pillar: publish a formal “Parents as Co-Teachers” program with specific trainings, book studies, and home-learning resources aligned to classical education principles.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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